

These 5 books completely changed my life

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 26, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/8-UVGY3jvWw> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter counts down his all-time top 5 books — spanning stoicism, power, emotional mastery, elite performance, and people skills — explaining exactly why each one impacted him personally.

Contents

-  #5: The Obstacle is the Way
-  #4: The 48 Laws of Power
-  #3: Awaken the Giant Within
-  #2: Relentless
-  #1: How to Win Friends and Influence People
-  Honorable Mention: The 7-Day AI Action Plan for Online Trainers

#5: The Obstacle is the Way 0:00

- Author not explicitly named, but the book is the classic by Ryan Holiday
- Core idea: turn problems, obstacles, and trials into advantages
 - Rather than being held back by obstacles, use them to propel you toward your goals

#4: The 48 Laws of Power 0:07

- Author: Robert Greene
- Common misconception: many people think it is purely a manipulation manual
 - Brandon's rebuttal: "You guys haven't read it, so you should probably shut the [up]"
- Actual value: Robert Greene is "just breaking down how the world works"
 - Two ways to apply it:
 - Use the patterns offensively — to your own advantage
 - Use the patterns defensively — to recognize when others are trying to take advantage of you

#3: Awaken the Giant Within 0:22

- Author: Tony Robbins
- Brandon calls this book a personal life-changer

- Biggest takeaway: Tony explains how to control your own emotions
 - Instead of letting other people or your circumstances dictate how you feel
 - Brandon admits: "Up until that point, I didn't think that was possible"
 - He describes his pre-book self as acting like a child — unable to control emotions and therefore unable to control behavior

"Some of y'all still acting like children and you're not able to control your own emotions. And because of that, you can't control your behavior."

#2: Relentless 0:45

- Author not named in transcript (book is by Tim Grover, trainer to Michael Jordan and Kobe Bryant)
- Brandon's enthusiasm: he liked it so much he had the word tattooed on his arm
- Core message: breaks down exactly what it takes to be the best you can possibly be in your field

#1: How to Win Friends and Influence People 0:57

- Author: Dale Carnegie
- Reason it tops the list: everything you want to do or accomplish in life requires dealing with other people
 - Learning to deal with people more effectively lets you go further yourself
 - It also helps you bring other people further along with you

Honorable Mention: The 7-Day AI Action Plan for Online Trainers 1:07

- Written by Brandon Carter himself
- Target audience: online fitness trainers
- Core promise: shows how to use AI to grow an online fitness business and start making money within 7 days